ENG-0012 - Incident Postmortem for INC-027

Impact

The incident involving the billing-worker system (SYS-009) was classified as Severity Level 2 (Sev2). Although the system's criticality is designated as low, the disruption lasted for approximately 12.5 hours, during which the system experienced deployment-related issues. The incident was reported by Debra Davidson, a Sales Executive, on February 13, 2025. The disruption potentially affected billing operations within the scope of Project Lattice, which is currently active under project owner E-033 and department D-03. Despite the low criticality, the extended resolution time underscored the importance of refining deployment procedures to prevent similar occurrences in the future.

Timeline

- **February 13, 2025:** The incident was reported by Debra Davidson regarding the billing-worker system.
- **Initial Detection:** The issue was identified during routine monitoring, prompting immediate investigation.
- **Response Activation:** Angelica Keith, serving as the on-call engineer for SYS-009, was notified and began troubleshooting.
- **Resolution:** The deployment error was rectified, and the system was restored to operational status after approximately 12.5 hours.
- **Post-Resolution:** A review was initiated to determine root cause and prevent recurrence.

Root Cause

The root cause of the incident was determined to be a deployment error. This error originated during a recent deployment process for the billing-worker system, which is part of Project Lattice. The deployment mistake was not caught during pre-deployment checks, leading to the system malfunction. The deployment error falls under the category of deployment_error, highlighting procedural gaps in deployment validation and oversight.

Action Items

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Conduct a comprehensive review of the deployment procedures for billing-worker and similar systems.	Project Lead (E-033)	2025-02-20	Focus on validation steps and approval workflows.
Implement additional deployment validation checks to prevent errors of this nature.	DevOps Team	2025-02-27	Automate validation where feasible.
Schedule training sessions for deployment teams to reinforce best practices.	HR & Training Department	2025-03-05	Emphasize error detection and rollback procedures.

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Review and update incident response protocols to reduce resolution time for future Sev2 incidents.	Incident Management Team	2025-02-25	Incorporate lessons learned from INC-027.
Monitor the billing-worker system closely for any residual issues post-deployment.	Angelica Keith (E-194)	Ongoing	Ensure system stability and early detection of anomalies.

This incident underscores the importance of rigorous deployment validation and proactive incident management. Continuous improvement in deployment procedures and incident response will enhance system stability and operational resilience for Project Lattice and related systems.